MS EXCEL · UNIT 3

Data Entry

Entering numbers, text and dates correctly

7	7	3	1
Topics	Practices	Data types	Class Results sheet

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The three types of data

3.1 · Theory

Text

Words, names, headings — not a number

Student Name

ALIGNS LEFT

e.g. Karachi, January

Numbers

Pure numbers used for calculations

1000

ALIGNS RIGHT

e.g. 85, 3.14, −50

Dates & Times

Recognised date or time formats

05/04/2026

ALIGNS RIGHT

e.g. 14:30, April 5

WATCH OUT

Number left-aligned? Excel treats it as text — it will NOT calculate with it.

Practice 3.1: Sheet headers

Practice · 1 of 7

GOAL

Create the column headings for your Class Results sheet.

1. Click `A1`. Type `Student Name` → Tab.
2. Type `Score` → Tab.
3. Type `Percentage` → Tab.
4. Type `Phone` → Tab.
5. Type `Date Joined` → Enter.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- All five headers align LEFT
- Left = Excel sees them as Text

Entering data

3.2 · Theory

Click the cell → type → confirm. Your data appears in the cell and in the Formula Bar.

`Enter`	Confirm and move DOWN one cell
`Tab`	Confirm and move RIGHT one cell
`Shift + Tab`	Confirm and move LEFT one cell
`Arrow Keys`	Confirm and move in that direction
`Esc`	Cancel — discard what you typed, keep the original
`F2`	Enter edit mode on an existing cell

TIP

Use Tab to move right when filling a row — then press Enter at the end to jump to the start of the next row.

Practice 3.2: Keyboard entry

Practice · 2 of 7

GOAL

Fill three rows with Tab and Enter, then try Esc and F2.

1. Click **A2**. Type **Ahmed Ali** → Tab.
2. Type **80** → Enter. The cursor drops to **A3**.
3. Type **Sara Khan** → Tab. Type **92** → Enter.
4. Type **Bilal Raza** → Tab. Type **78** → Enter.
5. Click **B3**. Type **99**. Press **Esc**.
6. Click **A2**. Press **F2**. Press **Esc**.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Names align LEFT
- Scores align RIGHT
- B3 still shows 92 after Esc
- F2 puts the cursor inside the cell

Entering text

3.3 · Theory

1

Text too long for column

PROBLEM

Text spills into the next column if it is empty, or gets cut off if the next column has data.

FIX

Widen the column by dragging its border — or double-click the border to auto-fit.

2

Number as text (phones, IDs)

PROBLEM

Typing `001234` — Excel removes the leading zero and stores the number 1234.

FIX

Type an apostrophe first: `'001234` — Excel then treats the entry as text.

3

Text wrapping inside a cell

PROBLEM

Long text spills into adjacent cells and can be hard to read.

FIX

Home tab → Alignment group → `Wrap Text` — text wraps onto multiple lines inside the cell.

Practice 3.3: Phone numbers

GOAL

Keep the leading zero in phone numbers.

1. Click D2. Type 03001234567 → Enter.
2. The zero disappeared! Click D2 → press Delete.
3. Type '03001234567 (apostrophe first) → Enter.
4. D3: type '03009876543 → Enter.
5. D4: type '03451122334 → Enter.
6. Double-click the border of the column D header.

YOU SHOULD SEE

03001234567 → 3001234567

'03001234567 → 03001234567

- Text aligns LEFT — the zero stays

Entering numbers

3.4 · Theory

Whole number	Just type the number	`150`
Decimal	Use a dot (.) not a comma (,)	`3.75`
Negative	Type a minus sign before the number	`-50`
Percentage	Type the number then % (stored as 0.85)	`85%`
Fraction	Type 0, a space, then the fraction — not 3/4!	`0 3/4`
Large number	Type without commas — format later	`1000000`
Currency	Type the number only — add Rs. with a format later	`5000`

WATCH OUT

Never type 3/4 directly — Excel reads it as March 4th (a date). Always use 0 3/4.

Practice 3.4: Fractions and percentages

Practice · 4 of 7

GOAL

Add Attendance with fractions — without making dates.

1. Click **F1**. Type **Attendance** → Enter.
2. **F2**: type **0 3/4** → Enter.
3. **F3**: type **1** → Enter.
4. **F4**: type **0 1/2** → Enter.
5. Type **85%**, **92%**, **78%** in **C2:C4**.
6. Click **C2**. Look at the Formula Bar.

YOU SHOULD SEE

`0 3/4` → **3/4**

`0 1/2` → **1/2**

- C2 shows 85% but stores 0.85
- Percentages align RIGHT

Entering dates and times

3.5 · Theory

What you type	What Excel recognises
`5/4/2026`	5 April 2026 (day / month / year)
`04-05-2026`	5 April 2026 (day - month - year)
`5 Apr 2026`	5 April 2026 (short month name)
`April 5`	5 April — current year assumed
`14:30`	2:30 PM (24-hour format)
`2:30 PM`	2:30 PM (12-hour format)

Dates are stored as numbers

1 Jan 1900 `= 1`

1 Jan 2000 `= 36,526`

5 Apr 2026 `= 46,117`

This is why date arithmetic works — e.g. finding the days between two dates.

Practice 3.5: Dates and times

Practice · 5 of 7

GOAL

Enter dates and times and check that Excel recognises them.

1. Type `5/4/2026` in `E2`.
2. Type `12/4/2026` in `E3`. Type `19/4/2026` in `E4`.
3. Type `Time` in `I1`.
4. Type `14:30` in `I2`. Type `2:30 PM` in `I3`.
5. Click `E2`. Look at the Formula Bar.
6. Select `I1:I3`. Press `Delete`.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- Dates align RIGHT — Excel sees them as dates
- Times align RIGHT too
- The Formula Bar shows the date Excel stored
- Times were removed to keep the sheet tidy

Editing cell content

3.6 · Theory

Replace content	Click the cell → type new data → Enter. The old content is overwritten.
Edit part of it	Double-click the cell (or press F2). Edit → Enter.
Delete content only	Click the cell → press Delete. Formatting stays.
Delete content and formatting	Select cells → Home → Editing → Clear → Clear All.
Undo a mistake	Ctrl + Z — works just like in Word. Press it several times to undo several steps.

TIP

Delete only removes data. Background colour and borders stay — use Clear All to remove everything.

Practice 3.6: Edit and correct

GOAL

Replace, edit, delete and undo.

1. Ahmed has `85`, not `80`. Click `B2`. Type `85` → Enter.
2. Double-click `A3`. Click after Sara and type `h` → Enter.
3. Click `B4`. Press `Delete`.
4. Press `Ctrl+Z` to bring it back.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- B2 shows 85
- A3 shows Sarah Khan
- B4 is back after Undo

Useful data entry tricks

3.7 · Theory

`Ctrl + Enter`

Fill many cells at once

Select all the target cells first → type your data once → press Ctrl + Enter instead of Enter.

Saves time when entering the same value in many cells.

`Enter`

AutoComplete

As you type, Excel suggests words from earlier entries in the same column. Press Enter to accept, or keep typing to ignore it.

Works for text only — not numbers or dates.

`Alt + ↓`

Drop-down from column

Press Alt + ↓ in any cell to see a list of all unique values already typed above. Click to select.

Keeps data consistent — no spelling variations.

Practice 3.7: Speed tricks

Practice · 7 of 7

GOAL

Fill a Status column quickly.

1. Click `G1`. Type `Status` → Enter.
2. Select `G2:G4`.
3. Type `Present` → press `Ctrl+Enter`.
4. Click `G5`. Type `Pr` → Enter to accept.
5. Click `G6`. Press `Alt+↓` → pick Present.

YOU SHOULD SEE

- G2:G4 all say Present
- G5 and G6 say Present
- Your Class Results sheet is complete!

Unit 3 — Key takeaways

3.1	Text aligns left — Numbers and Dates align right. Left-aligned numbers mean a problem.
3.2	Enter confirms down, Tab confirms right, Esc cancels, F2 opens edit mode.
3.3	Use an apostrophe (') to force a number to be stored as text.
3.4	Use a dot for decimals (3.75), type 0 3/4 for fractions, no commas in large numbers.
3.5	Dates are stored as numbers internally — this enables date arithmetic.
3.6	Delete clears content only. Use Clear All to remove content and formatting.
3.7	Ctrl+Enter fills many cells. AutoComplete and Alt+↓ speed up repeated entry.

Your completed Class Results sheet

Result

Built step by step in Practices 1–7 — every skill from Unit 3 in one sheet.

Student Name	Score	Percentage	Phone	Date Joined	Attendance	Status
Ahmed Ali	85	85%	03001234567	05/04/2026	3/4	Present
Sarah Khan	92	92%	03009876543	12/04/2026	1	Present
Bilal Raza	78	78%	03451122334	19/04/2026	1/2	Present

CHECK YOUR WORK

Text left, numbers and dates right, phone numbers keep their zeros, fractions show as fractions.